

to be the abode of all evil deeds. their coronation, their courtesy water (poured on them) from urns darkened (unfeeling), as if offered to Fire; their forgiveness rooms in the form of the tips of (in their hands); their remembrance approach of old age is covered by the folding of cloth of the of the next world is hidden (from an umbrella (held over their heads); and, as if with the breezes of their merits are driven away, as if by the din of the drums; good words (of advice) as if by the din of the drums; as if by the streamers of the kings come to be miserable as unsteady as the hollow neck of a fire-fly, and which are consumed; having forgotten their (real) arrogance caused by the acquisition of vehemence of passion; corrupt blood full of various senses, which, although only as it were, in their eagerness of desires; and being distracted by appears to have been multiplied of its having got free scope they are seized as it were by evil spirits; are possessed as it were (as it were) by evil spirits; and are swallowed (entirely) though pierced in their vital parts their faces into thousands by the heat of wealth, they hard blows, they possess limbs servants to support them). They were crabs. Their course of (or unjust) deeds, they are led

(guided in their course of action) by others, like lame persons, who are unable to walk (by themselves). They (condescend to) speak with great difficulty, as though suffering from ulcers in the mouths, as a result of telling falsehoods. By (their glances which are) the results of the operation of the quality of *rajas* (passion) as if due to the eye disease called *kusuma*, they produce a headache in those who move near them, like the *Saptachchhada* trees (causing headache) by the operation of the pollen of their blossoms. Like people about to die, they do not recognize even their relatives. Like persons with sore eyes who cannot look at bright objects, they cannot (bear to) look at men of spirit. As persons bitten by (deadly) black snakes cannot be restored to life even by means of mighty spells, they cannot be roused (into activity) even by means of excellent counsels. Like ornaments made of lac, which are unable to bear (the presence of) hot objects, they cannot bear spirited persons (near them). Being rendered insensible by the apathy due to their great pride, they do not listen to advice, as mad elephants made fast at their very large tying-posts (do not listen to the directions of their drivers). As persons fainting under the influence of thirst-like poison see everything golden, they, rendered insensible by the poison of greed, see all things as made of gold. Just as arrows, with sharpness increased by being whetted on a stone, destroy when discharged by the enemy, so they, whose cruelty is increased by drinking liquor, destroy (persons) at the instigation of others. By sending their armies they annihilate great families, although they stand far away from them (i.e., do not molest them in any way), just as men fell down fruit, though growing high up (a tree), by throwing sticks at them. Though charming in appearance, they bring distress upon people, just as the premature appearance of flowers (on a tree) does. Their prosperity is extremely frightful, like the ashes of cemetery-fires. They cannot see far (into the future), like persons suffering from (the eye-disease called) *timira* (corneal opacity or myopia). Just as persons possessed by evil spirits have their houses invested by bees, they have their houses occupied by low persons. Even when (merely) heard, they cause disgust like the drums in a funeral procession. Even when (merely) thought of, they bring disaster, just like resolves to commit a heinous sin. Being daily filled (with riches), they become puffed up in appearance, as though they are inflated with sin. And, being in such a condition, they become the targets of hundreds of vices and

ill, they become helpless and come to be the abode of all evil deeds. Thus :—At the very time of their coronation, their courtesy is washed away, as if with the water (poured on them) from auspicious jars; their heart becomes darkened (unfeeling), as if with the smoke of the sacrifices offered to Fire; their forgiveness is swept away, as if with the brooms in the form of the tips of the *kusa* grass held by the priests (in their hands); their remembrance of (the thought about) the approach of old age is covered over (i.e., forgotten), as if with the folding of cloth of the turbans (head-dresses); the sight of the next world is hidden (from them), as if with the large, circular umbrella (held over their heads); their truthfulness is blown away, as if with the breezes of the *chowries* (waved around them); their merits are driven away, as if with the cane-staffs (of the door-keepers); good words (of advice) are prevented from being heard (drowned), as if by the din of the cries of victory; and glory is blotted off, as if by the streamers of the banner-cloths. And also :—Some kings come to be miserable—being tempted by riches, which are as unsteady as the hollow neck of a bird hanging loose through exhaustion, which look charming for a short while only like the flash of a fire-fly, and which are condemned by (all) high-minded persons; having forgotten their (real condition at) birth owing to the arrogance caused by the acquisition of a little wealth; being affected by vehemence of passion increased by various misdeeds, as by corrupt blood full of various impurities; being harassed by their senses, which, although only five, appear to number many thousands as it were, in their eagerness to taste the various (sensual) pleasures; and being distracted by their mind, which although but one appears to have been multiplied a hundred thousand times, because of its having got free scope owing to its natural fickleness. They are seized as it were by evil stars; over-powered as it were by goblins; are possessed as it were by spells; are made stiff (in their limbs) as it were by evil spirits; are mocked as it were by delirium; and are swallowed (entirely possessed) as it were by devils. As though pierced in their vital parts by the arrows of Cupid, they distort their faces into thousands of shapes (i.e., frowns). As if boiled by the heat of wealth, they act frantically. As if struck with hard blows, they possess limbs (which) droop down, i.e., require servants to support them). They wander (i.e. act) crookedly, as if they were crabs. Their course of action being impeded by unrighteous (or unjust) deeds, they are led

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never know their own fall (i.e., degradation) even, just as drops of water hanging on the tips of (the blades of) grass on an ant-hill do not know their own fall [as they are quickly absorbed by the clay of the ant-hill].

There are others who are misled, by means of praises which can only fit superhuman beings, by rogues who are experts in cheating, who are intent on securing their own ends, who are (as it were) the vultures devouring the flesh of wealth, who are (as it were) the cranes surrounding the lotus-plant in the form of the (royal) audience-hall, and who, while themselves laughing inwardly, are (outwardly busy in) raising even faults (vices) to the side (grade) of virtues—representing gambling as a diversion; seducing other people's wives as cleverness; hunting as exercise; drinking as sport; carelessness as bravery; neglect of one's own wife as absence of (over-) addiction to sensual pleasures; disregarding the advice of the preceptor (or the elders) as a refusal to be ruled by others; the habit of not chastising one's servants (when guilty) as the mark of one's being easy to serve; addiction to dancing, to vocal and instrumental music, and to the company of harlots, as an evidence of one's (good) taste; listening (unmoved) to some atrocious crime as an exhibition of one's nobility of mind; putting up with insults as forgiveness; acting according to one's own will as asserting one's sovereignty; showing disrespect to the deities as a sign of great (moral) strength; the applause of bards as fame; rashness as energy; and inability to distinguish (between good and bad) as impartiality. (Such kings), whose minds are drunk with the pride of wealth, who having lost all discernment, become falsely vain of themselves by believing all that to be true; who although mortal by nature look upon themselves as partial incarnations of heavenly beings, as containing divinity within themselves, and (in fact) as superhuman beings; and who (accordingly), begin to act and conduct themselves in a manner fit only for celestial beings, and become the laughing stock of all people; and when their servants imitate them in their actions (act as servants of gods) they welcome it. Owing to the delusion caused by their mental attribution of divinity to themselves, and overpowered by an irrational conception, they look upon their pair of arms as having another pair of arms concealed within them (i.e., think themselves to be Vishnu, one pair of arms being suppressed within). They suspect their forehead as having a third eye hidden underneath its skin (since god Śiva has three eyes). The granting of

their sight they consider as a (great) favour. The casting of a glance they count on the side of (regard as) an obligation. Merely talking (with a person) they set down as a favour granted. Even a command they regard as a boon conferred. Even their touch they esteem as purifying. And over-filled (entirely puffed up) with the pride of false greatness they do not bow to the gods, do not reverence the Brāhmanas, do not honour those worthy of honour, do not worship those deserving of worship, do not salute those who deserve to be saluted, and do not rise (from their seats) to receive their elders (or preceptors). They laugh at learned men, as denying themselves in useless toil the joy of the enjoyment of sensual pleasures. They look upon the advice of old persons as the senseless prattle of senile dotage. They ill receive the counsel of a minister, thinking it to be an insult to their own intellect. And they get angry with one who gives them wholesome advice. In every way him they welcome, him they talk to, him they have by their side, him they advance, with him they stay with pleasure, him they give, him they admit to their friendship, his words they listen to, on him they shower gifts, him they honour, and him they make their trusted confidant, who with all other business set aside, and with folded hands praises them day and night and continuously, as if they were gods, or proclaims their greatness. And what is proper to them (fit to be done in the eyes of those kings) whose authority (for action) is the dreadful treatise (i.e., *Arthaśāstra*) of Kautilya which contains advice mostly of a very cruel nature;—whose spiritual guides are the priests whose nature is wholly cruel on account of their practice of malevolent magical rites;—whose advisers are ministers skilled in deceiving others;—who are deeply attached to Lakṣmi, enjoyed and then abandoned by thousands of kings;—who are sedulously given to study of such Śāstras as consist of directions for killing;—and to whom their (own) brothers, attached to them on account of their hearts being full of natural affection, are the persons to be annihilated?

Therefore, O Prince, in the administration of the kingdom which is mostly of the kind described above, and which is dreadful on account of thousands of extremely crooked and painful practices, and in this youth (of yours) which (generally) produces the greatest infatuation, you should strive (to conduct yourself) in such a way that you will not be laughed at by the people, nor censured by the good, nor condemned by your elders, nor reproached by your friends, nor grieved over by the wise;—Also that you may not be exposed by

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shows her height as measuring (equal to) that of several men (standing one over another) and drives a timid man into frenzy. She shows (successively) the elevation (rise to prosperity) of many (different) persons, and crazes a weak-minded person (or, makes him drunk with pride). As if out of jealousy, she embraces not a person who is favoured by Sarasvatī (the goddess of learning). She touches not a virtuous person, as if he were unholy. She does not think highly of a noble-minded person, as if he were something inauspicious. She does not (even) look at a good man, as at an evil omen. She passes over (avoids) a high-born person, like a snake. She shuns a brave person, as if he were a thorn (in her way). She does not remember (forgets to approach) a liberal man, as if he were an evil dream. She approaches not an educated person, as if he were a sinner. She mocks at a noble-minded person, as if he were a drunkard. And in this world she manifests her actions, as if she were exhibiting a juggler's tricks which (on their face) appear to be opposed to each other. For example:—Though always producing heat, she creates cold.¹ Though bestowing height she exhibits stuntedness.² Though sprung from the store of water, she increases thirst.³ Though she transforms one into Śiva, still she displays a nature that is not of Śiva.⁴ Though she increases one's strength, still she brings on lightness (loss of weight).⁵ Though she is sister of (produced from the same place as) nectar (which is sweet), still she gives rise to a bitter taste.⁶ Though she possesses a body,⁷ still her actual sight is invisible to the senses. Though attached to the best men, still she loves wicked persons.⁸

1 The real sense is—'she keeps a man in good spirits, and yet makes him dull'.

2 Real sense—'brings about an elevation of rank or position, and yet gives rise to meanness of character'.

3 Real sense—'she is born of the Ocean, and she increases one's avarice.'

4 Real sense—'she makes a man wealthy, and leads to vileness of character'.

5 Real sense—'she makes him highly powerful, and makes him weak-minded'.

6 Real sense:—'she brings disasters in her train'.

7 Real sense—'she is full of (foster) strife'. अन्तर्यामिनी may mean in the second case—makes a person long for things not actually within sight (reach)'.
8 Real sense—'she is attached to Vishnu, and she loves (favours) wicked persons'.

As if made of dust she soils even the pure.¹ And the more this fickle one blazes forth (makes a man more and more prosperous) the more does she give rise to actions, dark like lampblack, alone, just as the more the flickering flame of a lamp burns, the more does it produce black soot, (and nothing else). It is thus:—She acts as the nourishing stream of water to the poisonous creepers in the form of (evil) desires; as the song of a hunter to (for luring away) the deer in the form of the senses; as the obscuring line of smoke to the pictures in the form of good actions; as a luxurious bed to the long sleep of infatuation; as an old terrace for residence to the she-goblins in the form of pride of wealth; as the appearance of *timira* (opacity of the cornea) to the eyes in the form of the *S s ras*; as the banner borne in the van to all deeds of insolence; as the native river to the alligators in the form of the outbursts of violence; as the drinking ground to the wines in the form of pleasures; as the music-hall to the gestures in the form of the knittings of the eye-brows; as the residence-cavern (lair) to the pythons in the form of faults; as the cane-staff (for driving away people), to the words (of advice) of good men; as the untimely (setting in of the) rains, to the swans in the form of merits; as the (favourable) surface for spreading, to the tumours in the form of public scandals; as the prologue, to the drama in the form of deception; as the banner to (on the head of) the elephant in the form of lust; as the slaughter-house, to good intentions; and as the (eclipsing) tongue of Rāhu to the orb of the moon in the form of righteousness. And I do not see anyone who has not been (suddenly) very closely embraced by her though not familiar with him, and then deceived. Surely she will move away (i.e., leave a person), even when consigned to a picture (i.e., visualized mentally as sure of attainment); will produce illusions like magic, even when confined to books (i.e., made as steady as matter committed to books); she will deceive, even when (merely) engraved as a statue (in one's mind, i.e., when means be conceived to remove short-comings and make her steady); will cheat, even when (merely) heard of; and will take one in, even when (merely) thought about (leads men to seek her but they find her not).

And when in obedience to the will of destiny, kings are somehow favoured by her, who is of this description and behaves so

1 Real sense—'she makes even an honest person dishonest (or, warps the judgment of a man of pure thoughts)'.

ear-passages are stopped by the tumour in the form of unbridled arrogance, do not listen to what is said to them by way of advice. And, even when they listen, as they treat it with contempt in the manner of an elephant closing his eyes (and remaining indifferent to all that passes around), they pain their teachers who offer them beneficial advice. The kingly nature is always perturbed, being darkened by the swoon caused by the burning fever of self-conceit; riches produce the delirium in the form of false pride; and regal glory induces a coma brought on by the working of the poison of kingly power.

Let your honour, ever bent on doing what is good, consider (i.e. examine) Lakshmi (Goddess of wealth) herself first. This Lakshmi, who is (as it were) the bee sportively moving about in the lotus-bed of the circle of the swords of brave warriors, (first) arose from the Milky Ocean, bringing with her these mementos to lighten (the pangs of) separation, on account of her fondness for them due to (long) residence together; viz. (she brought) *rāga* (passion) from the leaves of the Pārijāta tree (which possess *rāga*—redness); extreme *vaikṛatā* (perverseness) from the crescent-moon (which possesses *vaikṛatā*—curvedness); *chāṇchalatā* (unsteadiness) from (the horse) Uchchaisravas (who possesses *chāṇchalatā*—fleetness); the power of *mohana* (infatuating) from (the deadly poison) Kālakṛtā (which possesses the power of *mohana*—causing swoon); *māda* (arrogance) from wine (which possesses *māda*—drunkenness); and extreme *naishikūrya* (cruelty) from the Kaustubha gem (which possesses *naishikūrya*—hardness). There is nothing else in this world which is so regardless of (the tie of) familiarity (i.e. friendship) as this wicked dame (Lakshmi). (For) even when obtained, she is retained with great difficulty. Though made fast (secure) by being tied with the ropes of merits, she vanishes. Even when held fast (confined) within the cage (i.e. cage-like array) of the thin, long swords brandished (wielded) by thousands of extremely proud (very heroic) warriors, she escapes. Though guarded all round by the dense columns of elephants darkened with the showers of their rut-water, she slips away. She cares not for (the tie of) familiarity; regards not noble birth; looks not to beauty; has no respect for hereditary connexion; looks not on character or virtue; counts (minds) not cleverness (culture); has no ear for learning; regards not righteousness; honours not munificence; takes no heed of discrimination (one's power to distinguish merit from demerit);

observes not customary duties; takes no account of truth; and she sets no value upon (a person's possessing) auspicious marks. Like the outline of the city of the Gandharvas¹ she vanishes just as one is looking at her. She wanders about (i.e. from person to person) as though she is still under the influence of the giddy sensation caused by her being whirled round in the whirl-pool made by the turnings of the Mandara mountain. She nowhere plants her foot firmly, as though a thorn from a lotus-stalk were run into it on account of her roamings in lotus-beds. Even when held firmly with very great efforts, in the palaces of great kings, she reels aside, (goes away) as if intoxicated by drinking wine (i.e. ichor) from the temples of numerous scent-elephants. She dwells (i.e. depends for stability) on the edges of swords, as if to learn *pārushya* (cruelty) from them which possess *pārushya*—keenness). She clings to (the chest-region of) the body of Nārāyaṇa, as if to learn *viśvarūpa* (presenting all kinds of illusory appearances) from him, who possesses *viśvarūpa*—the state of having the whole universe contained in his form). Full of apprehension (i.e., having no confidence for the most part in one), she leaves a king, even though he may have well enriched (made good additions) to his inherited territory, his army, his treasury, and the number of princes subordinate unto him, as she does a lotus at the close of the day although it may have a well developed root, stalk and its circular pericarp. Like a creeper which climbs branches of trees, she dwells with persons who patronize parasites (voluptuous persons). Like Gaṅgā who although she gave birth to the (eight) Vasus is restless with her ripples and bubbles, she, although the producer of wealth, is yet as fickle as the bubbles of waves. Like the movement of the sun which exhibits the various stages of his passage from one zodiacal sign to another, she exhibits her own fitting movements (from one person to another). Like a cave of the Nether Regions which is full of darkness, she is full of dark deeds. Like (the demoness) Hidimbā whose heart was captivated solely by the daring deeds of Bhīma, she is one whose heart can be attracted only by deeds of stupendous daring. Like the rainy season which produces lightning, she produces a short-lived glow (display of prosperity). Like a wicked she-goblin who

¹ The phantom of a city in the sky due to some meteorological cause, so called.